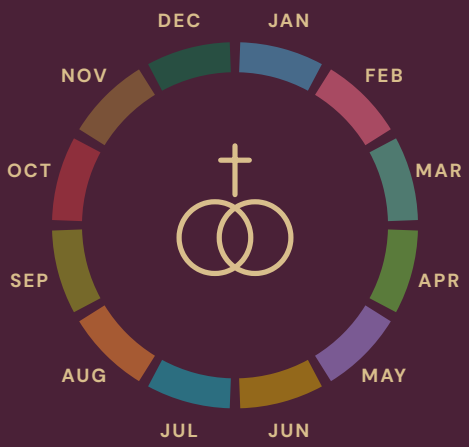
MONTHLY MARRIAGE CHECK-IN

12-Month Marriage Growth Calendar



PURPOSE

Build emotional, sexual, spiritual, and financial intimacy through small, measurable habits.

EMOTIONAL SEXUAL SPIRITUAL FINANCIAL

START HERE

How to *Use It*

Complete one monthly challenge at a time. Hold a **weekly 30–45 minute marriage check-in** to discuss progress, pray, review the calendar, and adjust goals without shame or blame.

→ WEEKLY MARRIAGE MEETING AGENDA · P. 16

EVERY MONTH INCLUDES

- Marriage challenge
- Emotional intimacy
- Sexual intimacy
- Spiritual growth
- Financial goal
- Measurable outcome

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE

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TRACK THESE EACH WEEK

Monthly *Scorecard*

MONTH _____

AREA	WEEKLY GOAL	WEEK 1	WEEK 2	WEEK 3	WEEK 4
Marriage check-in	1	☐	☐	☐	☐
Meaningful conversation	2	☐☐	☐☐	☐☐	☐☐
Intentional affection/ intimacy time	1	☐	☐	☐	☐
Pray together	3 times	☐☐☐	☐☐☐	☐☐☐	☐☐☐
Financial review	1	☐	☐	☐	☐
Date/quality time	1	☐	☐	☐	☐

✓ One box for each time you reach the weekly goal — tap to check.

MONTH 1 OF 12

January

Reset, Vision, and Unity

01

MARRIAGE CHALLENGE

Create a shared vision for the year.

- [ ] Schedule a 60–90 minute planning date.
- [ ] Each spouse identifies three hopes for the marriage, family, faith, health, and finances.
- [ ] Write a one-sentence marriage mission statement.

EMOTIONAL INTIMACY

Ask: "*What would help you feel more loved, secure, and supported this year?*"

SEXUAL INTIMACY

Have an honest, pressure-free conversation about affection, needs, desires, comfort, frequency expectations, and obstacles. Focus on understanding, not performance.

SPIRITUAL GROWTH

Pray together for the year and choose one Scripture verse or theme for your marriage.

FINANCIAL GOAL

Create a one-page annual financial plan:

- Monthly income
- Fixed expenses
- Debt balances
- Savings goal
- Planned major expenses
- Giving goal, if applicable

MEASURABLE OUTCOME

Complete the written marriage vision and financial plan by the end of the month.

DONE

MONTH 2 OF 12

February

Appreciation and Affection

02

MARRIAGE CHALLENGE

Practice daily appreciation.

- [ ] Share one specific thing you appreciate about your spouse each day.
- [ ] Write one handwritten note, card, or message of encouragement each week.

EMOTIONAL INTIMACY

Learn or revisit each other's preferred ways of receiving love: words, time, acts of service, gifts, or physical affection.

SEXUAL INTIMACY

Prioritize non-sexual affection every day—hugging, holding hands, kissing, cuddling, or affectionate touch—with no expectation that it must lead to sex.

SPIRITUAL GROWTH

Read 1 Corinthians 13 together and discuss one action you can take to demonstrate patient, selfless love.

FINANCIAL GOAL

Set a monthly "marriage fund" for dates, shared activities, or relationship resources.

MEASURABLE OUTCOME

Record at least 20 appreciations and complete four intentional acts of affection or encouragement.

DONE

MONTH 3 OF 12

March

Communication and Conflict

03

MARRIAGE CHALLENGE

Improve how you handle disagreement.

- [ ] Use a “pause and return” agreement when emotions run high.
- [ ] Practice speaking with “I feel,” “I need,” and “Can we…” statements.
- [ ] Resolve one recurring minor conflict with a written agreement.

EMOTIONAL INTIMACY

Each spouse answers: *“What makes it easier—and harder—for me to share honestly?”*

SEXUAL INTIMACY

Discuss how conflict, stress, fatigue, body image, schedules, and emotional connection affect intimacy. Identify one barrier you can reduce together.

SPIRITUAL GROWTH

Pray before difficult conversations. Read James 1:19 and Ephesians 4:29.

FINANCIAL GOAL

Identify and cancel or reduce one unnecessary recurring expense. Direct those funds to savings, debt reduction, or the marriage fund.

MEASURABLE OUTCOME

Use the communication framework in at least two difficult conversations and document one agreement.

DONE

MONTH 4 OF 12

April

Friendship and Fun

04

MARRIAGE CHALLENGE

Rebuild friendship.

- [ ] Plan four low-cost dates or connection activities.
- [ ] Try one new activity together: cooking, hiking, game night, class, project, or local outing.
- [ ] Ask each other curiosity questions instead of focusing only on logistics.

EMOTIONAL INTIMACY

Ask: *"What are you enjoying lately? What are you looking forward to? What feels hard right now?"*

SEXUAL INTIMACY

Make time for playfulness, romance, and affectionate connection. Discuss what helps each spouse feel pursued and desired.

SPIRITUAL GROWTH

Thank God together for the joys in your marriage. Share one answered prayer or blessing each week.

FINANCIAL GOAL

Complete a "no-spend" challenge for one weekend or one category of discretionary spending.

MEASURABLE OUTCOME

Complete four dates or intentional connection activities while staying within the agreed budget.

DONE

MONTH 5 OF 12

May

Service and Shared Load

05

MARRIAGE CHALLENGE

Reduce each other's burdens.

- [ ] List all household, family, and administrative responsibilities.
- [ ] Divide or rebalance tasks fairly based on current capacity.
- [ ] Each spouse completes one unrequested act of service weekly.

EMOTIONAL INTIMACY

Ask: "*Where do you feel overwhelmed, unseen, or unsupported?*"

SEXUAL INTIMACY

Recognize that practical support can strengthen emotional safety and openness. Create margin for connection by reducing avoidable stressors.

SPIRITUAL GROWTH

Read Galatians 6:2. Pray specifically for your spouse's burdens.

FINANCIAL GOAL

Create sinking funds for predictable expenses, such as vehicle maintenance, holidays, travel, school needs, or home repairs.

MEASURABLE OUTCOME

Agree on a task-sharing plan and fund at least one savings category with an initial contribution.

DONE

MONTH 6 OF 12

June

Health, Rest, and Margin

06

MARRIAGE CHALLENGE

Protect energy and rest.

- [ ] Set one device-free evening each week.
- [ ] Take one walk or do one healthy activity together weekly.
- [ ] Review schedules and remove one unnecessary commitment.

EMOTIONAL INTIMACY

Discuss: "*What drains me? What restores me? How can we protect rest for each other?*"

SEXUAL INTIMACY

Talk openly about conditions that help both spouses feel relaxed, emotionally available, and connected. Prioritize mutual care, respect, consent, and communication.

SPIRITUAL GROWTH

Practice a weekly Sabbath rhythm: worship, rest, gratitude, and reduced productivity pressure.

FINANCIAL GOAL

Review health-related and insurance costs. Set a realistic monthly amount for medical, wellness, or fitness expenses as appropriate.

MEASURABLE OUTCOME

Complete four device-free evenings and remove or modify one recurring source of unnecessary stress.

DONE

MONTH 7 OF 12

July

Trust and Transparency

07

MARRIAGE CHALLENGE

Strengthen trust through openness.

- [ ] Share calendars, major commitments, and upcoming decisions.
- [ ] Discuss digital boundaries, friendships, work relationships, and social media expectations.
- [ ] Make one clear agreement that protects trust.

EMOTIONAL INTIMACY

Ask: *"What helps you feel secure in our relationship?"*

SEXUAL INTIMACY

Create a safe space to discuss boundaries, expectations, and any unresolved concerns without criticism, pressure, or comparison.

SPIRITUAL GROWTH

Read Psalm 139:23–24 and pray for honesty, humility, and integrity.

FINANCIAL GOAL

Conduct a full financial transparency review: accounts, debts, subscriptions, savings, credit reports, and upcoming obligations.

MEASURABLE OUTCOME

Both spouses understand the full household financial picture and document one trust-building agreement.

DONE

MONTH 8 OF 12

August

Personal Growth and Encouragement

08

MARRIAGE CHALLENGE

Support each other's individual development.

- [ ] Each spouse chooses one personal goal: spiritual, professional, physical, creative, or relational.
- [ ] Identify one way the other spouse can provide support.
- [ ] Celebrate effort, not just results.

EMOTIONAL INTIMACY

Ask: "*What dream, concern, or goal have you not talked about enough?*"

SEXUAL INTIMACY

Discuss how each spouse can feel more confident, accepted, and emotionally safe in intimacy. Replace criticism with reassurance and curiosity.

SPIRITUAL GROWTH

Choose a personal devotional practice and a shared couple practice for the month.

FINANCIAL GOAL

Set aside a planned amount for one personal-development goal, such as a course, book, certification, hobby, or wellness activity.

MEASURABLE OUTCOME

Each spouse completes four sessions toward a personal goal and receives weekly encouragement from the other.

DONE

MONTH 9 OF 12

September

Financial Teamwork

09

MARRIAGE CHALLENGE

Build a stronger money partnership.

- [ ] Hold a weekly 20-minute money meeting.
- [ ] Review spending without blame.
- [ ] Agree on spending thresholds that require joint discussion.
- [ ] Decide on one short-term and one long-term financial goal.

EMOTIONAL INTIMACY

Discuss childhood experiences and beliefs about money, security, generosity, debt, and success.

SEXUAL INTIMACY

Acknowledge that financial stress can affect connection. Make financial conversations respectful and keep intentional couple time protected.

SPIRITUAL GROWTH

Discuss stewardship, contentment, generosity, and gratitude. Pray for wisdom and unity in financial decisions.

FINANCIAL GOAL

Choose measurable targets, such as:

- Save $_____ toward an emergency fund.
- Pay an extra $_____ toward debt.
- Reduce discretionary spending by $_____.
- Build a $_____ sinking fund.

MEASURABLE OUTCOME

Complete four weekly money meetings and track progress toward the selected target.

DONE

MONTH 10 OF 12

October

Romance and Pursuit

10

MARRIAGE CHALLENGE

Intentionally pursue one another.

- [ ] Plan one date that reflects each spouse's preferences.
- [ ] Re-create an early memory or favorite date.
- [ ] Send a thoughtful message during the day at least twice weekly.

EMOTIONAL INTIMACY

Ask: "*When do you feel most pursued, valued, and chosen by me?*"

SEXUAL INTIMACY

Schedule protected private time for intimacy and connection, while remaining flexible and attentive to each other's wellbeing and consent. Discuss ways to make intimacy more emotionally connected, mutually enjoyable, and free of pressure.

SPIRITUAL GROWTH

Pray that your marriage would reflect faithful, sacrificial, joyful love.

FINANCIAL GOAL

Plan a realistic annual anniversary, getaway, or special-experience fund. Divide the total cost into monthly savings targets.

MEASURABLE OUTCOME

Complete two intentional dates and make the first contribution to your shared experience fund.

DONE

MONTH 11 OF 12

November

Gratitude, Generosity, and Family Culture

11

MARRIAGE CHALLENGE

Build a culture of gratitude.

- [ ] Share three things you are grateful for each day.
- [ ] Serve someone together through practical help, hospitality, giving, or volunteering.
- [ ] Discuss the traditions and values you want your home to reflect.

EMOTIONAL INTIMACY

Ask: "*What do you want our home to feel like for us, our family, and our guests?*"

SEXUAL INTIMACY

Express appreciation for your spouse as a whole person—not only appearance or sexual availability. Strengthen warmth, friendship, and affectionate connection.

SPIRITUAL GROWTH

Read Colossians 3:12–17 together. Practice gratitude in prayer.

FINANCIAL GOAL

Set a holiday spending plan before holiday purchases begin. Include gifts, travel, meals, hosting, charitable giving, and unexpected costs.

MEASURABLE OUTCOME

Follow the agreed holiday budget and complete one shared act of generosity or service.

DONE

MONTH 12 OF 12

December

Reflection, Celebration, and Renewal

12

MARRIAGE CHALLENGE

Celebrate growth and prepare for the next year.

- [ ] Review the year's highlights, hardships, answered prayers, and lessons.
- [ ] Name three ways your spouse grew or blessed you.
- [ ] Discuss what habits to continue, change, or stop next year.

EMOTIONAL INTIMACY

Ask: "*What did you need from me this year that I gave well? What do you still need more of?*"

SEXUAL INTIMACY

Reflect respectfully on your intimacy and affection: What strengthened connection? What created distance? What would each spouse like to carry into the next year?

SPIRITUAL GROWTH

Pray a prayer of thanksgiving, confession, forgiveness, and renewed commitment. Choose a spiritual focus for the coming year.

FINANCIAL GOAL

Review annual financial progress:

- Savings gained
- Debt reduced
- Budget categories that worked or failed
- Major expenses ahead
- Adjusted goals for next year

MEASURABLE OUTCOME

Complete a year-end marriage review and set three shared goals for the next 12 months.

DONE

USE THIS THROUGHOUT THE YEAR

Weekly Marriage *Meeting Agenda*

1	Open in prayer	2 minutes
2	Share appreciation	5 minutes
3	Emotional check-in	10 minutes
4	Address one concern early	10 minutes
5	Review calendar and responsibilities	10 minutes
6	Review finances and goals	5–10 minutes
7	Plan connection, date time, and intimacy	5 minutes
8	Close in prayer	2 minutes

FOR EACH GOAL, WRITE

Simple Goal-Setting *Framework*

GOAL	What are we trying to accomplish?
WHY	Why does it matter to our marriage?
ACTION	What will each spouse do this week?
MEASURE	How will we know we are making progress?
REVIEW DATE	When will we review and adjust it?

✧ EXAMPLE

GOAL	*Build a $1,000 emergency fund.*
WHY	*Reduce financial stress and increase security.*
ACTION	*Transfer $125 to savings each month.*
MEASURE	*Check the balance during the weekly financial review.*
REVIEW DATE	*End of each month.*



The objective is steady faithfulness, *not perfection.*

If a month is difficult, acknowledge it, extend grace, and resume with one small next step together.

